

AI Research

Consumer AI Survey – OpenAI and Google Out Ahead

Equities

Americas
Software

Summary

With our semi-annual UBS Enterprise AI survey now in its 5th iteration and an established input for investors assessing enterprise AI adoption, we are launching our inaugural UBS Consumer AI survey to better understand consumer choices of AI products and how they're using these tools. We surveyed 3,000+ individuals, split equally between the US, Europe and China. Bottom line, consumer use of AI products is already widespread, with OpenAI ChatGPT and Google Gemini dominant in the US and Europe and Bytedance Doubao dominant in China.

OpenAI ChatGPT Firmly in the Lead

The publicly-available data offered by OpenAI and Google suggests that ChatGPT has the largest seat base among the consumer AI products, followed by Google Gemini with Microsoft Copilot a distant third. Indeed, that is what our survey points to, with OpenAI ChatGPT comfortably in the lead in the US/Europe and also globally. While Google Gemini's progress is impressive, we conclude that there is plenty of room for two in the consumer AI market, we didn't pick up evidence of disappointing ChatGPT traction and it was reported recently that OpenAI's CEO said that ChatGPT is "back to exceeding 10% monthly growth", resulting in a rally in the OpenAI-exposed stocks. As such, we didn't pick up any evidence to suggest that OpenAI's need for ChatGPT inference compute from Microsoft and other partners was waning. xAI Grok and Anthropic Claude are distant rivals to OpenAI and Google in the consumer AI market, with xAI being much smaller and Anthropic being much more enterprise-focused. The share figures sum to well over 100%, indicating that many (most?) respondents use two or more AI products. In China, where the US products are effectively blocked, Bytedance Doubao dominates, followed by Tencent's Yuanbao.

Snapshot of Consumer Use

We pressed on HOW consumers were using products such as ChatGPT and a few things stood out: 1. The vast majority of users were not paying, leaving OpenAI and others with a material free-to-paid conversion opportunity. 2. In terms of frequency of use, it's clearly rising, with the sharpest increase being the portion of respondents that are using these tools once a day or more (now 23%, and frankly, we're surprised this is not higher). The region with the highest frequency of use was China. 3. A full 35% of the consumer use of these products was for professional use. It could be that many organizations have sanctioned products such as Microsoft Copilot but that many employees are turning to their personal OpenAI ChatGPT or Google Gemini versions. 4. Only 22% of respondents said that they'd stop using AI products if ads were introduced, and 15% said that they would respond by upgrading to a paid ad-free version. These results tell us that OpenAI has a material opportunity on the ad front and that the churn risk appears manageable. With 90%+ of ChatGPT users on the free tier, we are entirely sympathetic to OpenAI attempting to add a monetization source to cover the costs of serving this customer segment.

Karl Keirstead

Analyst
karl.keirstead@ubs.com
+1-310-734 2455

Stephen Ju

Analyst
stephen.ju@ubs.com
+1-212-882 5192

Wei Xiong

Analyst
S1460518100005
wei.xiong@ubs.com
+86-21-3866 8883

Dean Marriott

Associate Analyst
dean.marriott@ubs.com
+1-212-713 2115

Context for this Survey

Let's set some context for this survey before showing the results.

AI Surveys for Both Enterprises and Consumers

For the last 2-3 years, we've published a semi-annual edition of our Enterprise AI Survey, utilizing the UBS Evidence Lab data team to survey ~130 enterprise AI executives about a host of AI topics, from their choice of models, underlying hardware, cloud infrastructure services to topics such as AI adoption hurdles, M365 Copilot seat costs and what data software vendors get pulled along. We should be out in a few months with our 6th iteration of this survey, with previous surveys including:

- December 16, 2025 - [5th Edition](#)
- June 26, 2025 - [4th Edition](#)
- January 7, 2025 - [3rd Edition](#)
- June 24, 2024 - [2nd Edition](#)
- December 17, 2023 - [1st Edition](#)

What we haven't created or published to date is a survey of consumers/individuals and their use of AI products such as OpenAI ChatGPT and Google Gemini. This in our view is important given that OpenAI derives ~60% of its revenues, an estimated 85% of paid ChatGPT seats and the bulk of total (paid and unpaid) 900 million ChatGPT seats from consumers. Likewise, of 750 million Google Gemini users, only 8 million are for paid enterprise seats. At this still-early phase of AI adoption, consumers are still deriving the bulk of seats and most of the Azure-based inference compute that has been stood up by Microsoft is still to serve consumer ChatGPT queries. To offer a more thorough review of AI adoption, we present this inaugural consumer AI survey that we'll also publish on a semi-annual basis.

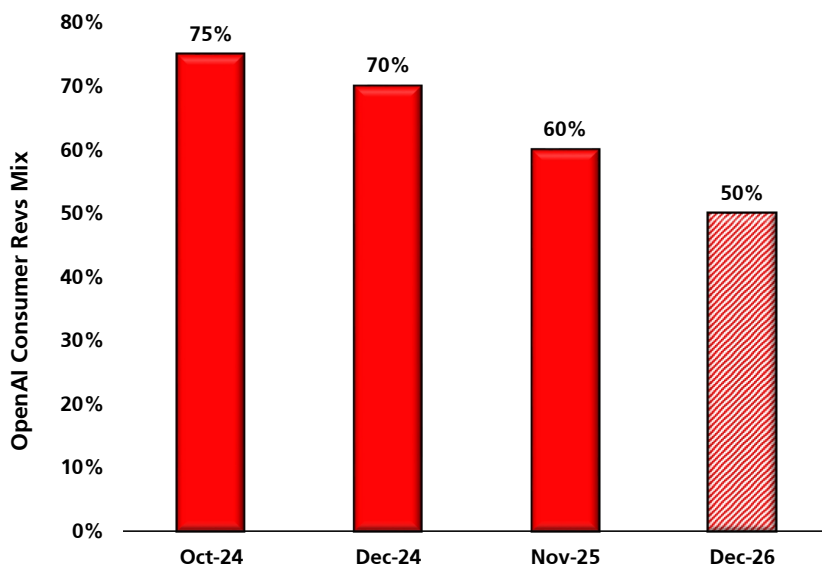
OpenAI Disclosures

The two dominant providers of consumer AI tools – OpenAI and Google – do make periodic disclosures of total seats and other metrics. Let's review this public data before discussing the results of our independent survey, starting with what OpenAI has shared publicly.

OpenAI's Consumer-Enterprise Mix

OpenAI has offered occasional consumer-enterprise mix comments, as we show in Figure 1 below. If OpenAI is now at a revenue run-rate of ~\$25 billion with ~60% from consumer, then OpenAI's consumer revenue stream is now ~\$15 billion, enormous growth from essentially zero in 2022. Given that Anthropic has a very small presence in consumer and xAI Grok's paid seat base is still relatively small, OpenAI is the dominant consumer AI provider alongside Google.

Figure 1: Mix of OpenAI Revs from Consumer

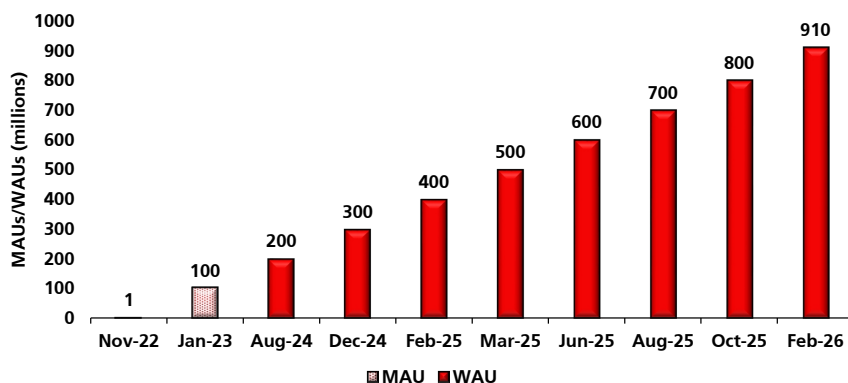


Source: The Information, CNBC, Management commentary

ChatGPT Seats – 900 Million Total, 50 Million Paying

The bulk of OpenAI's ~\$15 billion in consumer segment revenues comes from consumer ChatGPT subscriptions. As we show in Figure 2 below, OpenAI discloses ChatGPT weekly average users (WAUs), now at 900 million and up from 400 million this time last year, for 125% y/y growth. This trajectory – to almost 1 billion users globally in about 3 years – is one of the most impressive product growth ramps ever in the technology sector. OpenAI recently disclosed its paid subscriber count at 50 million or 6% of the 900 million. With a full 94% of ChatGPT users on the free version, OpenAI has plenty of room to drive paid seat growth from the free user base.

Figure 2: OpenAI ChatGPT WAUs

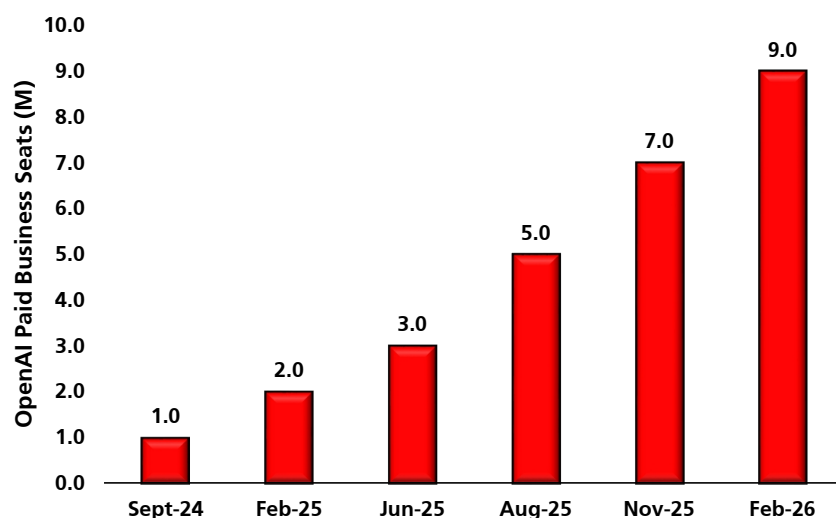


Source: OpenAI, The Information

ChatGPT for Business – 9 Million Paying Seats

As noted in Figure 3 below, OpenAI now has 9+ million paying business users on ChatGPT, up from 2 million in the year-ago period, for y/y growth of 350%. We wrote a report back in November 2025 about OpenAI's enterprise push (see link [here](#)) and we bring up this figure to make the point that of the 50 million paying ChatGPT subscribers, 41 million or 82% are therefore consumer. Given the y/y business user growth rate of 350% and the much larger and more mature consumer use base, today's 82%/18% consumer-enterprise mix of ChatGPT will likely shift over time to more business users.

Figure 3: ChatGPT For Business Users

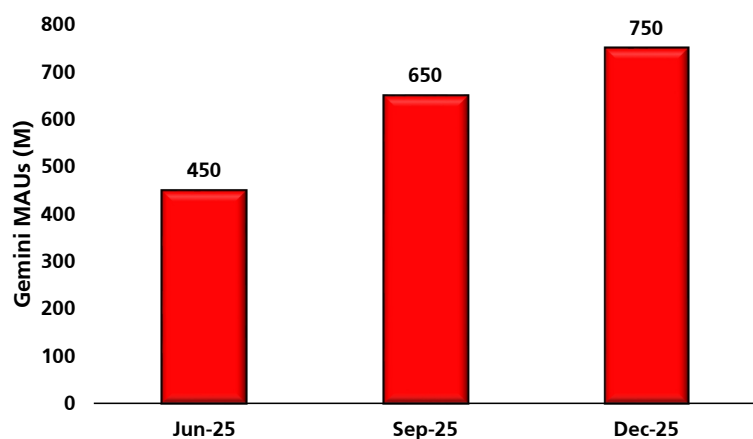


Source: The Information, OpenAI

Google Seat Disclosures

On its recent 4Q25 earnings call, Google disclosed 750 million MAUs on its Gemini AI application up from 450 million just two quarters ago. Note that this is a monthly active user (MAU) measure, while the OpenAI ChatGPT disclosures are for weekly active users (presumably Google Gemini WAUs, to make the compare to ChatGPT's 900 million users fair, would be quite a bit lower than 750 million). Google also disclosed 8 million paid Gemini Enterprise seats in just 4 months (up from 2 million just three months ago), very strong growth relative to the most recent 9 million paid OpenAI ChatGPT business seat disclosure. A lot of value is in the (undisclosed) details, as a good portion of Google Gemini for Enterprise seats could be from Google advertisers using Gemini to create ad/video content. Regardless, it appears as if Google Gemini has emerged as the #2 consumer AI tool on the basis of the public seat disclosures. While Google has rolled out tiered subscription plans for Gemini - from a \$7.99 per month (\$3.99 for first 2 months) AI Plus, a \$19.99 AI Pro tier, and a \$124.99 for three months AI Ultra tier - these do come bundled with other services such as YouTube Premium ad-free as well as storage for Gmail, Drive, and Photos. From an enterprise/seats perspective, the YouTube bundle may make less sense but as compute costs continue to come down it is quite possible for Google to extend the value proposition (while at the same time driving further penetration) to its existing subscribers by taking down the price over time. As for the consumer-facing monetization potential, it does seem like the path of least resistance will be to monetize via ads although we expect the company to take its time coming to a decision focusing instead to grow utility and build its audience instead.

Figure 4: Google Gemini MAUs



Source: Company reports

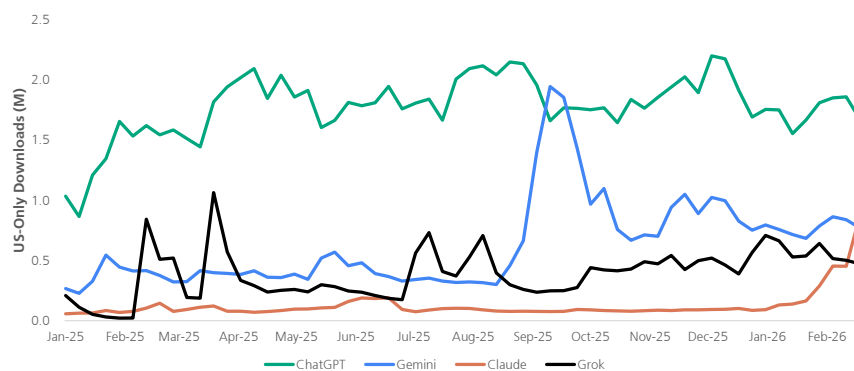
Microsoft Copilot Disclosures

Following the OpenAI and Google seat disclosures, Microsoft threw its hat in the seat disclosure ring on its 4Q/Jun 2025 earnings call via a statement that it reached a 100 million MAU user count for its “Copilot family” of products. That number increased to 150 million on the 1Q/Sept earnings call. This is obviously a fraction of the numbers from OpenAI and Google but Microsoft’s user base would have a much higher mix from enterprise users. Microsoft confirmed that a large portion of the 150 million comes from commercial use of M365 Copilot, including 15+ million paid M365 Copilot users, but this figure also includes 26+ million total GitHub Copilot users (4.7 million paid) along with consumer Copilot use (as part of M365 subscriptions but also via the Copilot mobile app) and Copilot Chat users. It’s tough to estimate the Copilot consumer reach with any precision, but these figures imply that it is substantially lower than OpenAI with ChatGPT and Google with Gemini.

3P Consumer AI Usage Metrics

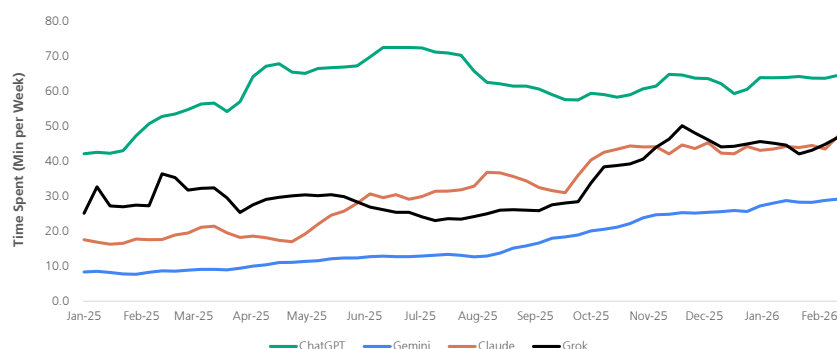
Given that OpenAI is such a large concentrated customer for Microsoft, Oracle, Datadog and other tech firms, and given that ChatGPT subscriptions are the majority of OpenAI revenue today, any actual or perceived shift in ChatGPT use or hint at slowing or accelerating seat growth, can cascade through a host of tech stocks and result in material swings in stocks. For example, the popular “buy Google and sell the OpenAI complex of stocks” trade in 4Q25 was partly precipitated by a comment made on an investor call by the OpenAI CFO that ChatGPT usage growth had moderated. Conversely, a Feb 9th internal statement by the OpenAI CEO (see link to report [here](#)) that ChatGPT is “back to exceeding 10% monthly growth” resulted in a sharp rally in the OpenAI-exposed stocks. As such, the Street is now carefully monitoring the release of any third-party (3P) data about consumer AI product use, such as the Sensor Tower data that we show in Figures 5 and 6 below. One goal of this survey is to offer investors another source of consumer AI adoption data to supplement what they may be getting from these 3P sources.

Figure 5: 3P Data on Downloads [US Only]



Source: Sensor Tower

Figure 6: Time Spent per Week on Apps



Source: Sensor Tower

A Word on OpenClaw

Over the last few months, the open source AI agent OpenClaw has created a sensation in tech circles, with consumer downloads spiking since the introduction in November 2025 and motivating OpenAI to acquire the open source project and hire OpenClaw's founder Peter Steinberger for \$1 billion. OpenClaw adoption went viral AFTER we sent out this survey, but we wanted to touch on it given that it has opened up a new consumer AI market that goes beyond the use of tools such as OpenAI ChatGPT and Google Gemini. OpenClaw is an open source AI agent that runs locally on user devices (popularly deployed on Apple's Mac Mini) and executes multi-step workflows autonomously. OpenClaw sits on top of third-party LLMs as an orchestration and execution layer using a persistent agent loop, meaning that it can act on schedules (i.e. run tasks at set times), coordinate actions across multiple apps and self-correct without human prompting. These capabilities enable consumers to run a personal device-hosted AI assistant, deploying it for use cases like managing email, calendars and files systems.

To highlight just how popular OpenClaw became in such short a time, OpenClaw has already accumulated ~280k GitHub stars (a proxy for developer interest and adoption, essentially a like button) in just 3 months. For context, this already exceeds the star count for Facebook's React (widely used front-end web framework) and Linux, both of which took over a decade to exceed 200k stars. We hear anecdotes about Mac Mini's being sold out in NYC Apple stores and in the spirit of writing this section of the report while we're in Asia, we've heard of OpenClaw tutorial sessions being mobbed in Shanghai. At an investor conference last week, Nvidia's CEO Jensen Huang said "the biggest phenomenon that's happening is OpenClaw, probably the single most important release of software ever, the single most downloaded open source software in history and it took three weeks, I've never seen anything like it".

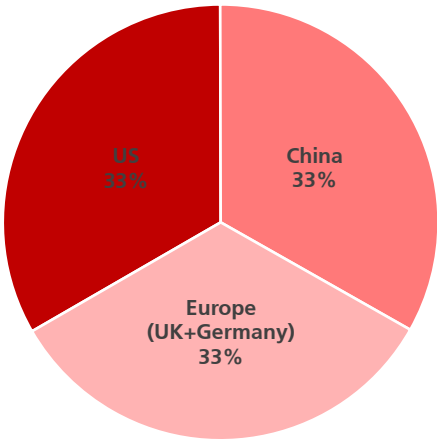
OpenClaw’s popularity is important in a number of ways. At a high level, it serves as evidence that consumer interest in personal AI-based technology is immense. We can imagine the leadership teams at OpenAI, Google, Microsoft and many other consumer-focused tech firms reflecting on this OpenClaw moment and doubling-down on consumer AI product research efforts. OpenAI’s CEO Sam Altman posted on X that OpenAI will “drive the next generation of personal agents” and that “this will quickly become core to our product offerings.” While enterprise adoption of OpenClaw may take some time given security and data access risks, OpenClaw’s popularity could spur on efforts to adopt secure enterprise AI agents. We’ll explore this topic more thoroughly in a separate Microsoft report, but personal agents such as OpenClaw, coupled with Anthropic Claude Cowork and OpenAI modules like ChatGPT for Excel create a new competitive environment for Microsoft’s crown jewel Office franchise.

Mix of Survey Respondents

Before discussing the survey results, we’ll share some details about the respondents.

- **Date:** The survey results were collected during the period from mid-December 2025 to late-January 2026.
- **Scale:** In total, we surveyed 3,024 individuals about their AI use.
- **Demographic:** Respondents were evenly split between male and female and roughly evenly split by age group. That said, the under-24 portion of 11 % was the lowest and the over-65 portion of 21% was the highest, in our view modestly impacting the usage results as we describe in the report.
- **Geography:** As noted in Figure 7 below, the 3,000+ respondents were split about evenly between the US, Europe (UK and Germany) and China. While the responses from the US and Europe were similar, in some cases the responses from China-based AI users were different enough (in part because OpenAI ChatGPT and Google Gemini are blocked in China) that we offer survey results from just US/Europe or in some cases we point out how usage patterns differ geographically.

Figure 7: Geographic Mix of Respondents

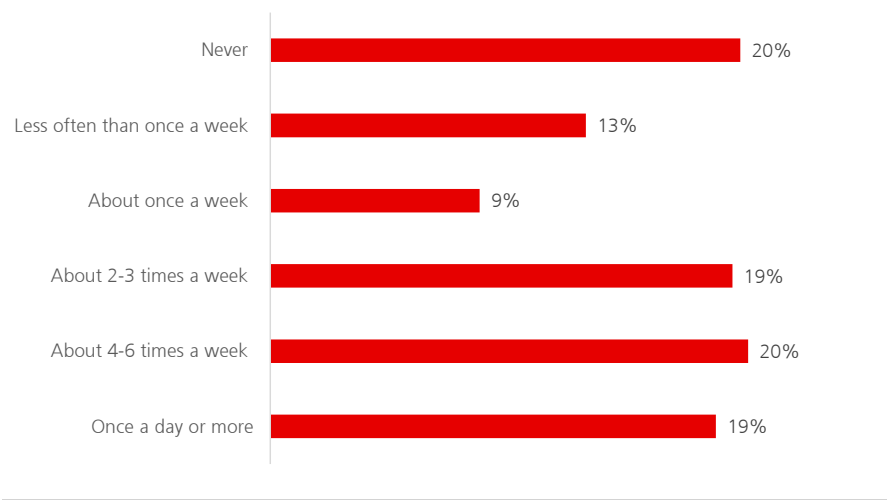


Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([> Access Dataset](#))

Choice of Consumer AI Product

Let’s begin with a review of the most popular consumer AI products, and then we’ll discuss usage patterns.

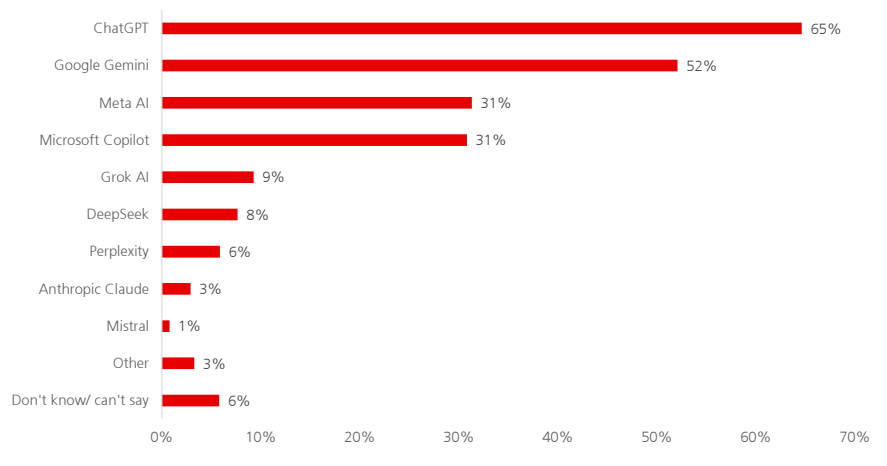
Figure 8: Do you Currently Use an AI Chatbot?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([> Access Dataset](#))

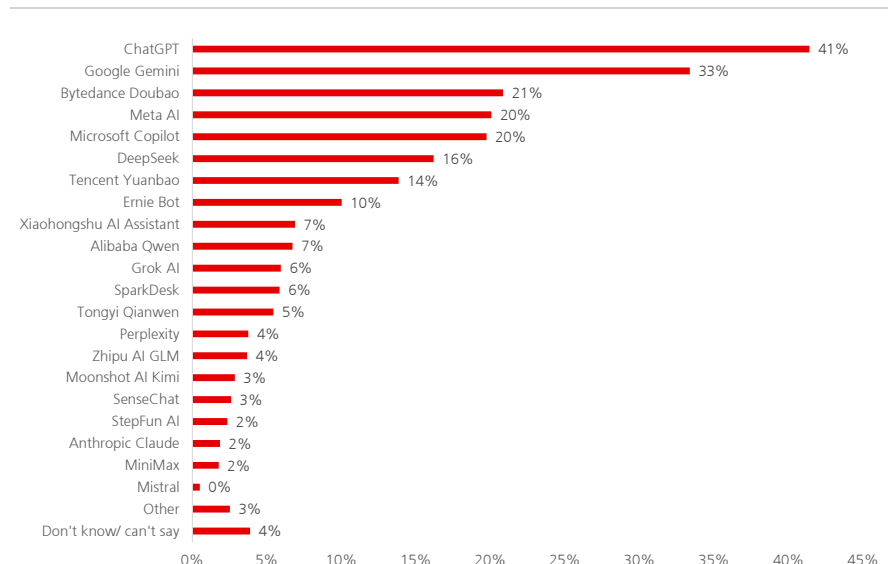
UBS: As a starting point, 80% of the 3,024 survey respondents in the US, Europe and China now use one or more consumer AI products, whether free or paid. It’s worth highlighting at the outset that this is an extraordinary figure given that this market is only ~3 years old. There are very few consumer technology products in history – perhaps none? – that have gone from zero to 80% global adoption in just three years, evidence of the real value that consumers are deriving from these products.

Figure 9: Which of the following AI-powered chatbots are you currently using? [US and Europe ONLY]



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([> Access Dataset](#))

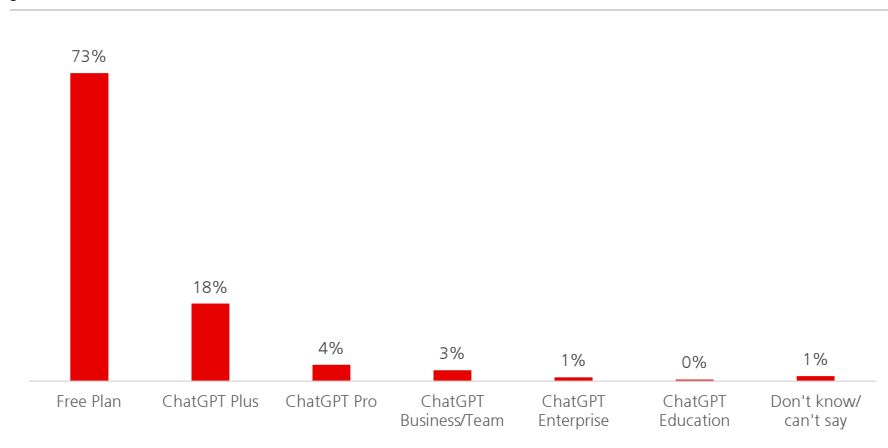
Figure 10: Which of the following AI-powered chatbots are you currently using? [GLOBAL]



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

UBS: The publicly-available data that we highlighted in the opening section suggests that OpenAI ChatGPT has the largest seat base among the consumer AI products, followed by Google Gemini. Indeed, that is what our survey points to, with OpenAI ChatGPT the leading AI product in the US/Europe and also globally. Two things are of note. First, the share figures sum to well over 100%, indicating that many (most?) respondents use two or more AI products. Second, the share results for OpenAI ChatGPT and Google Gemini decline materially in the global results chart in Figure 10, for the simple reason that these two leading consumer products are blocked in China. In the last section of the report, we shine the spotlight specifically on the Chinese products. In the US/Europe, readers may be surprised to see Meta AI rank so highly. This in our view is a function of consumers using Meta AI while inside of Meta products, a very different use case compared to a standalone (often paid) ChatGPT or Gemini product. With that in mind, Meta has previously disclosed the Meta AI user base as being in excess of 1 billion. As we have previously noted, the company has been fairly adept at driving incremental adoption of various engagement formats (Stories, Reels) among its user base and one of the new product directions in 2026 should be an improved consumer experience for Meta AI. As it has done for other products, we expect Meta to focus on gaining adoption/engagement for now but longer term it will look to monetize Meta AI engagement via ads. Note that xAI Grok and Anthropic Claude are distant rivals to OpenAI and Google in the consumer AI market, with xAI being much smaller and Anthropic being much more enterprise-focused.

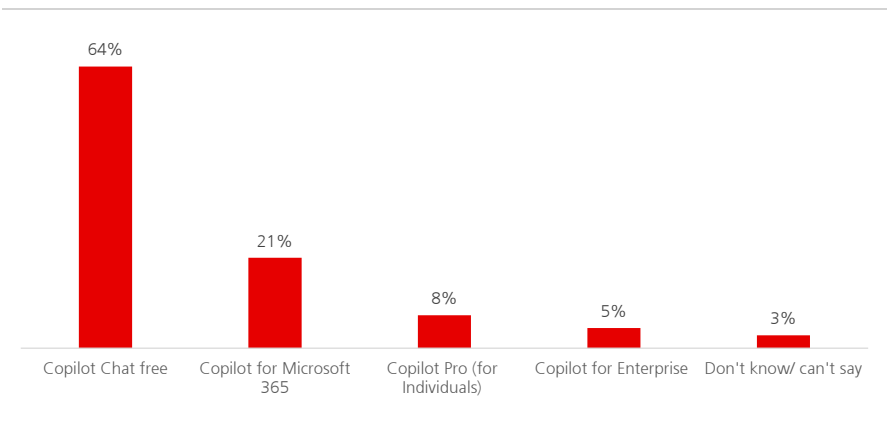
Figure 11: You said that you are using ChatGPT.... Which subscription plan do you have?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

UBS: We noted above that OpenAI recently disclosed that of its 900+ million users, 50 million or 6% are paying customers, therefore 94% use the free version. As we show in Figure 11 above, our survey showed that 73% are using the free version. The difference could be due to the fact that our survey was confined to the US and Europe (ChatGPT is not available in China so these results are for the US/Europe only), which likely have a higher mix of paid users compared to regions such as India that we didn't survey and that likely have a much higher skew to the free version. What is interesting here is that even in the US and Europe, a full 73% of ChatGPT users are on the free version, giving OpenAI plenty of room to drive paid seat growth from this enormous free user base. If indeed the US and Europe ChatGPT user base is 73% free, then this also suggests that OpenAI must be incurring substantial compute costs to provide inference to free users, not only weighing materially on profitability (and in part explaining any profitability difference with Anthropic) but also justifying OpenAI's introduction of an advertising tier to essentially cover these inference costs.

Figure 12: You said that you are using Microsoft Copilot... Which subscription plan do you have?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

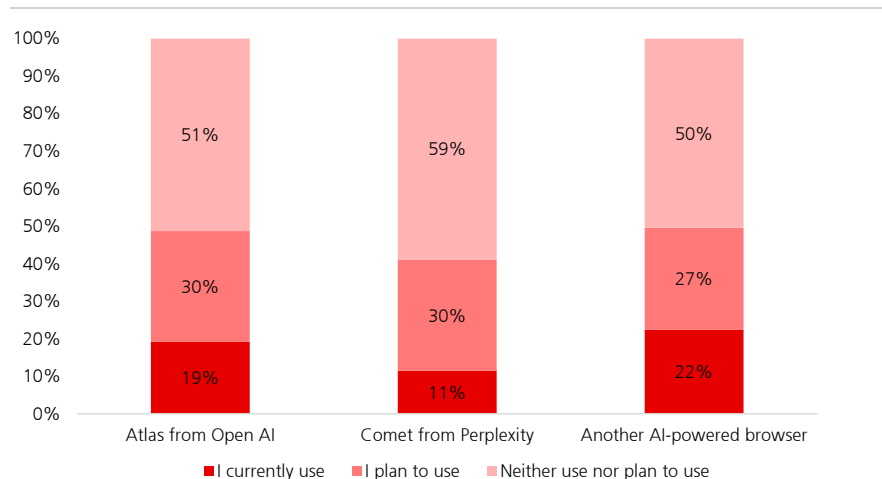
UBS: Microsoft offers two key SKUs for consumers – a standard version of Copilot is free and offers basic chat as well as services such as image creation prompts (albeit subject to usage caps), while M365 Premium (formerly known as Copilot Pro) is sold for the same \$20 per month as OpenAI ChatGPT Plus. As noted above, the vast majority – 85% – of consumer Copilot use is on the free chat and standard versions and only 8% are paying up for the Premium/Pro version. We noted above that OpenAI has said that 6% of its 900 million base is on paid subscriptions, so not that different. The point here is that the vast majority of consumer AI use (we're assuming the same is true for Google Gemini) is free.

Figure 13: Before today, had you heard about AI-driven browsers such as Atlas from OpenAI or Comet from Perplexity that are designed to compete with traditional browsers?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

Figure 14: Which, if any of the below AI-powered browsers do you currently use or do you plan to use?



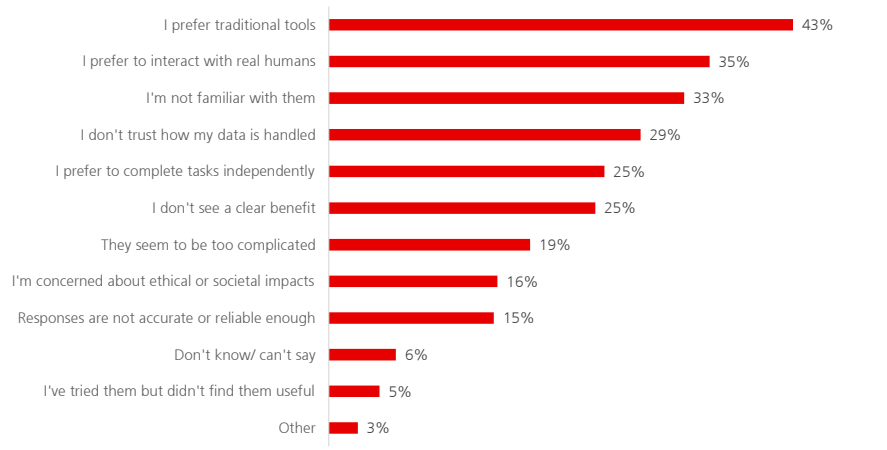
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

UBS: The other consumer-focused AI technology we asked about was at the browser level, given that OpenAI, Perplexity and Google have announced new AI-native browsers that serve as an alternative to Google Chrome and others (see link [here](#) to a report we wrote about these new AI browsers). The key take here is that we are very early-stage in this market. Over 70% of respondents were either unaware of them or admitted to not knowing what exactly they can do. As noted in Figure 14 above, OpenAI’s Atlas browser appears to have an early lead, although we suspect that Google will retain a material presence here as it embeds AI into its popular Chrome browser (via its “auto browse” features).

How Consumers Use AI Technology

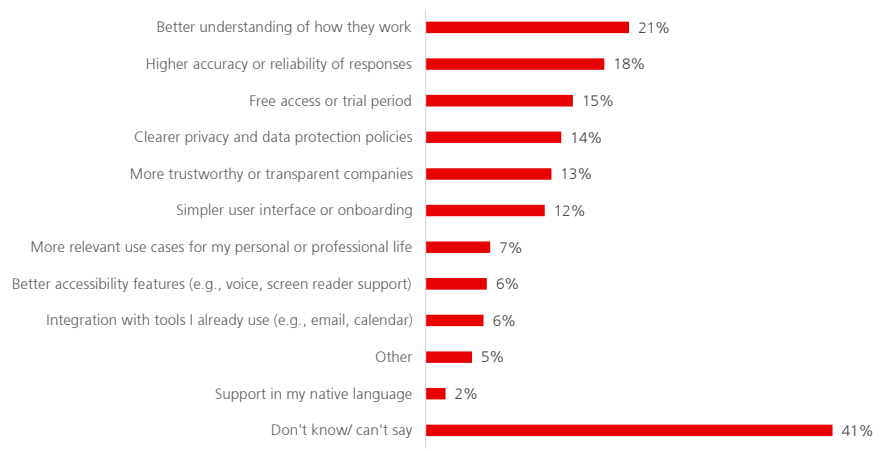
Now let's turn to a review of how consumers use tools such as OpenAI ChatGPT and Google Gemini. Note that in Sept 2025, a group of OpenAI researchers published a report (see link [here](#)) entitled "How People Use ChatGPT". Our survey might help to supplement that report.

Figure 15: You said that you are not using AI-powered chatbots...What are your reasons for not using AI-powered chatbots?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([> Access Dataset](#))

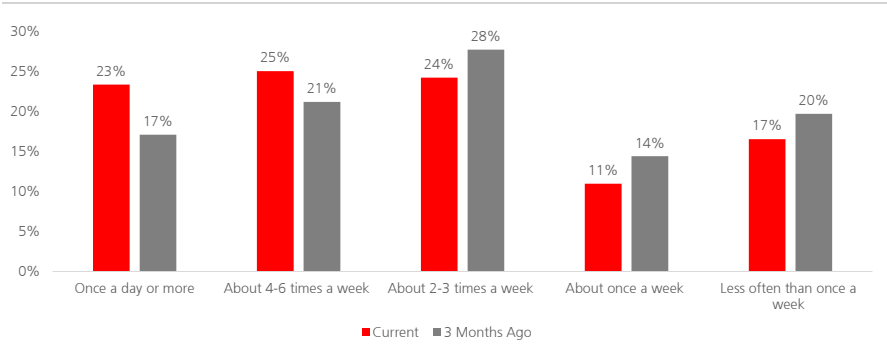
Figure 16: What would encourage you to start using AI-powered chatbots (like ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Gemini, Meta AI, DeepSeek, Doubao)?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([> Access Dataset](#))

UBS: The reasons for NOT using tools like ChatGPT or Google Gemini (to be clear, this was a minority that do not use these tools already) vary as we note above, from lack of familiarity, lack of confidence in the accuracy of responses or uncertainty in terms of data privacy. In our view these are blockers that will fade over time. Geographically, there were some differences in the responses to call out. Notably, while US and European survey respondents flagged issues such as "I prefer to interact with humans", "I prefer traditional tools", "I have ethical concerns" and "I prefer to complete tasks independently", very few China-based respondents cited these concerns (we wonder if this is a reflection of an age gap).

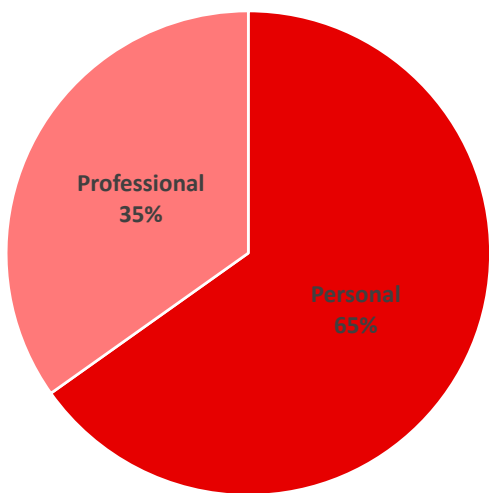
Figure 17: How often, if at all, do you currently use AI-powered chatbots, like ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Gemini, Meta AI, DeepSeek, Doubao? How often, if at all, did you use them 3 months ago?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

UBS: In terms of frequency of use, it’s clearly rising, with the sharpest increase being the portion of respondents that are using these tools once a day or more (now 23%, and frankly, we’re surprised this is not higher). Only 28% of respondents were using the tools just once per week or less frequently. Geographically, the region with the highest frequency of use was China.

Figure 18: How are you primarily using these tools, for personal or professional use?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

UBS: While this initiative was about surveying consumer use of AI products, it is interesting to note that a full 35% of the consumer use of these products was for professional use. As such, the official metrics disclosed by OpenAI about “business users” likely under-estimate the degree of professional use. It could be that many organizations have sanctioned enterprise products such as Microsoft Copilot but that many employees are turning to their personal OpenAI ChatGPT or Google Gemini version to answer questions.

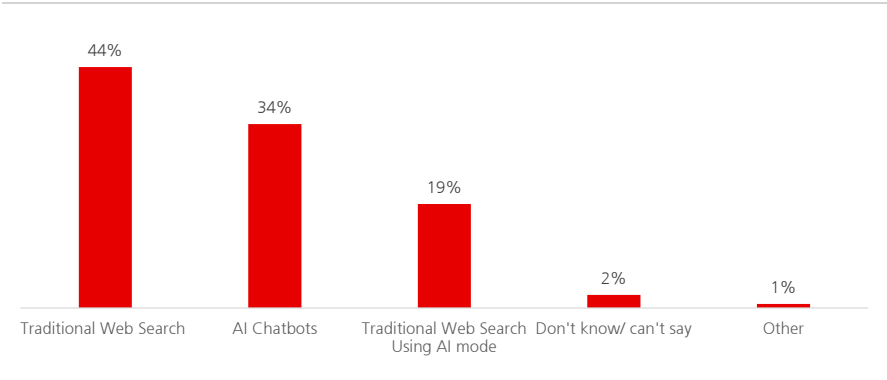
Figure 19: For each of the following generative AI-powered chatbots you are using, please select the types of tasks you use them for.

	ChatGPT	Microsoft Copilot	Google Gemini	Anthropic Claude	DeepSeek	Grok	Meta	Average
Search/ seeking information	18%	17%	20%	16%	14%	16%	18%	17%
Learning and research	16%	14%	16%	12%	13%	15%	14%	14%
Creativity and generating ideas	12%	10%	11%	10%	11%	12%	12%	11%
Summarizing documents and emails	10%	12%	9%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%
Translations	8%	8%	10%	10%	8%	8%	8%	9%
Shopping	8%	8%	10%	9%	6%	6%	9%	8%
Data analysis and visualisations	8%	8%	7%	7%	11%	9%	8%	8%
Creating presentations or reports	7%	9%	6%	7%	9%	9%	6%	8%
Automating repetitive tasks	6%	8%	5%	9%	8%	7%	8%	7%
Coding and technical support	5%	5%	5%	8%	7%	5%	5%	6%
Other	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	1%	1%
Don't know/ can't say	0%	0%	0%	1%	0%	1%	1%	0%

Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

UBS: In terms of how consumers are utilizing these tools, we’re not surprised to see that “search” and “learning and research” were the most frequently mentioned, as these are typical use cases in lieu of using Google search. Also notable were the number of consumers using these tools for creative tasks, partly a function of how good these tools have become for things like image generation. Also worth flagging was the number of consumers using these tools for traditional productivity tasks such as summarizing documents and emails and creating presentations and reports, tasks that they likely have traditionally used consumer versions of Microsoft Office and Google Workspace for.

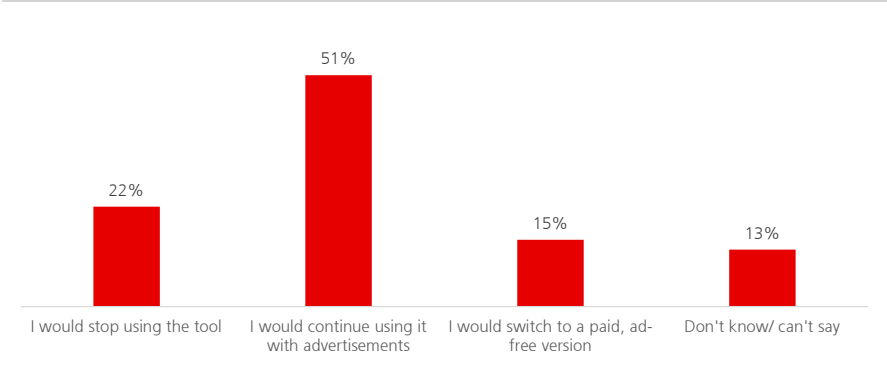
Figure 20: Now thinking about when you need to look up something online...Which of the below tools do you tend to use the most?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

UBS: If we hone in on the search use case, we asked the respondents for how they complete online searches these days, with a full 34% now turning to tools such as ChatGPT, presumably at the expense of traditional web search on Google or Bing. Google has of course responded to this threat and in our survey, a smaller but still material portion of respondents were using Google’s AI Mode in traditional web search.

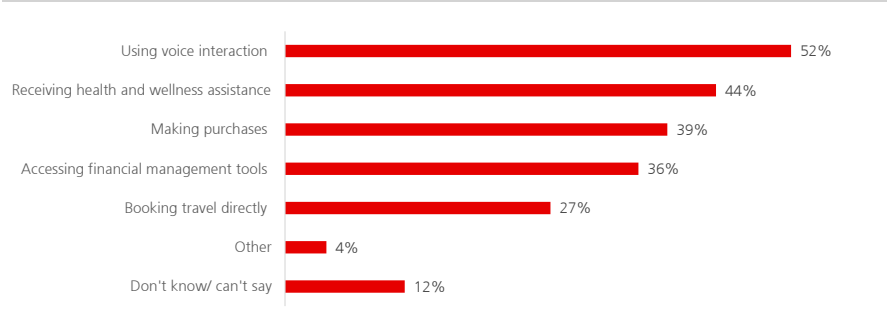
Figure 21: If your AI-based tool provider (e.g., ChatGPT from OpenAI/DeepSeek) introduced advertising into its AI-powered tools how would you most likely respond?



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

UBS: Anticipating that OpenAI would likely launch an ad-based tier, we inserted this question into the survey and indeed, while we were collecting results OpenAI formally launched an ad tier in its free version. As noted above, 94% of ChatGPT users don't pay for the service, and hence we are entirely sympathetic to OpenAI attempting to add a monetization source to cover the costs of serving this customer segment. The survey results were interesting, notably the fact that only 22% of respondents said that they'd stop using the tool if ads were introduced, and 15% said that they would upgrade to a paid ad-free version. These results tell us that OpenAI has a material opportunity on the ad front and that the churn risk appears manageable.

Figure 22: If your AI-based tool provider (e.g., ChatGPT from Open AI/ DeepSeek) introduced new functionalities to the product, which of the following would be most interesting to you?



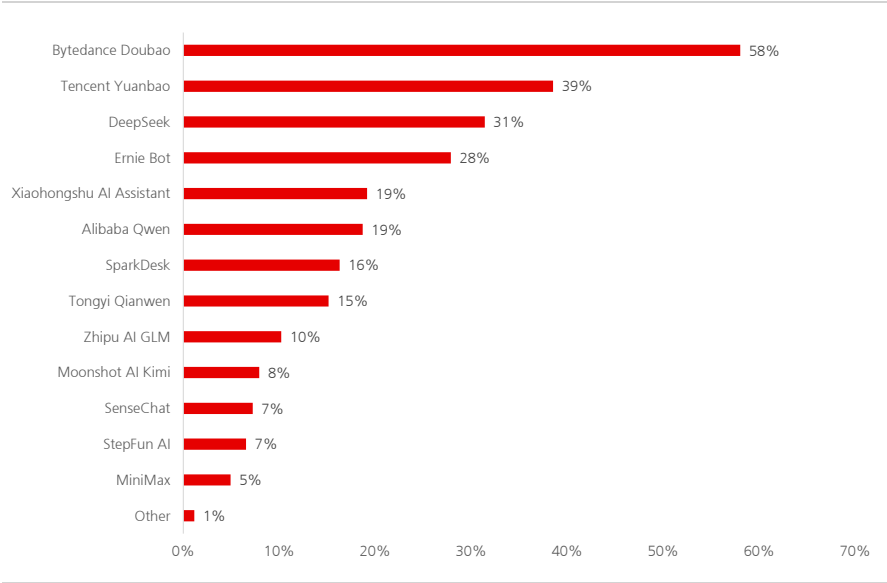
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

UBS: It seems clear to us and investors that OpenAI, Google and others have barely begun monetizing their now-huge base of consumer customers and that more product features and monetization avenues are coming. To help investors anticipate which new paths are most likely, we asked respondents for their views of what they'd like to see. Better voice interaction landed first, but we were most intrigued by those interested in "making purchases", "accessing financial management tools" and "booking travel directly", commerce features that could have an impact (good and bad) on incumbent internet commerce and travel firms. From an OpenAI perspective, we suspect it will be able to consolidate some but perhaps not all of the shopping and travel inventory (especially the longer tail) - as Shopify as well as others have already indicated a willingness to work on Agentic products. Similarly for Google it has recently [announced Universal Commerce Protocol](#) - to enable merchants to show products in places like AI Mode and Gemini. In our view this is no different from its current role as it already indexes web-based content for presentation on either Google Search, Shopping, or other surfaces. Our conversations with merchants suggest that LLMs in general are driving a small percentage of the overall traffic - therefore a decision to block say an OpenAI from indexing will not be a deleterious decision. However as Google currently delivers a greater amount of free/SEO traffic, we believe it has greater leverage among merchants as being more indispensable.

Spotlight on Chinese AI Products

As noted, a full one-third of our survey respondents were based in China.

Figure 23: Which of the following AI-powered chatbots are you currently using? [China ONLY]



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([> Access Dataset](#))

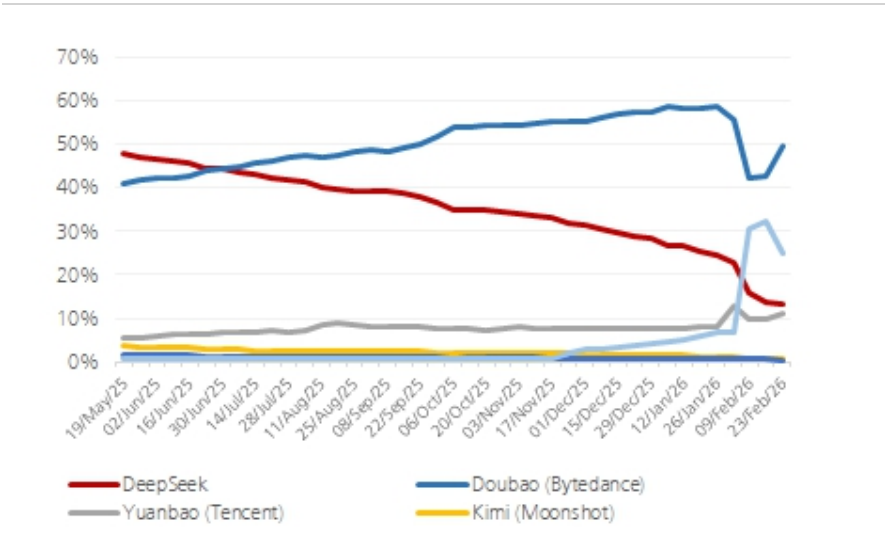
UBS: Today, OpenAI ChatGPT and Google Gemini are blocked in China, with access only available via the use of an overseas service provider or a VPN. As such, the choice of consumer AI products looks completely different from the US and Europe and is more local. The most popular AI products – by far – appear to be Bytedance’s Doubao, followed by Tencent’s Yuanbao.

Insights from Our China Tech Research Team

The survey results indicate that Bytedance’s Doubao is the most popular AI product, which is consistent with QuestMobile’s active user data showing Doubao has been leading among consumer-facing AI chatbots. We also want to highlight Alibaba Qwen’s recent momentum in user growth since Feb 2026 aided by increased promotional efforts (i.e. red-packet campaigns) around the Chinese New Year period, which is not captured by the Evidence Lab survey results. Alibaba officially launched the Qwen app in Nov 2025 (an upgrade from its previous AI chatbot “Tongyi”) as its key consumer-facing product, and it further integrated Alibaba’s existing ecosystem to provide more comprehensive agentic features, including local services, travel booking, ticketing, retail consumption and payment-related tasks.

Compared to the US market (with ChatGPT and Gemini as the duopoly in consumer AI products), we see a more fragmented landscape among China’s AI chatbots. With internet incumbents stepping up efforts in promotion and product upgrade, we see the potential for consolidation among China’s AI chatbots over time. Along with a well-established user base and the comprehensive ecosystems of internet incumbents, this could facilitate the emergence of consumer-facing AI super apps in China as new traffic gateways ([note](#)).

Figure 24: Weekly Active User (WAU) share of major AI chatbots in China



Source: QuestMobile; Note: The above data is as of Feb 23 2026

Figure 25: Comparison of China's AI chatbot product features

Company	Chatbot products	Agentic functions
Alibaba	Qwen	• Integrated Alibaba ecosystem services and enables users to complete multi-step tasks in one flow, from intent understanding to transaction and fulfillment. • Key services include: Local services, travel booking, ticketing, retail consumption, payment-related tasks.
ByteDance	Doubao	• Integrates chat, writing/coding, translation, and multimodal creation functions (including image/video generation), and etc.
Tencent	Yunbao	• Launched Yuanbao Pai as a multi-user AI collaboration space, extending Yuanbao from single-user chat into social and group-based AI-assisted interaction. • Key functions: Group collaboration, social content interaction, and lightweight shared task coordination.
Baidu	Ernie	• Integrates chat, Q&A, image generation/understanding, document reading, copywriting, and translation, while extending into agent-style workflows through plugin/tool calling and task orchestration.

Source: Company data, UBS

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Global AI Consumer Survey ([➤Access Dataset](#))

This report leverages the following UBS Evidence Lab asset: Global AI Consumer Survey. This survey of consumers in the US, the UK, Germany and China provides a view on consumer awareness, usage and attitude towards Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI).

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Investing in the technology sector entails above-average risk given low sales visibility, rapid pace of innovation and technological change, intense competition, frequent M&A, and low barriers to entry in many markets.

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Sell	Stock price expected to fall within three months from the time the rating was assigned because of a specific catalyst or event.	<1%	<1%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 31 December 2025.

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